

$$\Delta \left(\begin{array}{c} \text{square with arrows} \end{array} \right) = \begin{array}{c} \text{horizontal arrow} \end{array} \begin{array}{c} \text{vertical arrow} \end{array} - \begin{array}{c} \text{horizontal arrow} \end{array} \begin{array}{c} \text{vertical arrow} \end{array}$$

The diagram shows the expansion of a triangle of a square loop. The square loop has arrows indicating a clockwise direction: the top edge points left, the right edge points up, the bottom edge points right, and the left edge points down. The result is the difference between two products of arrows: a horizontal arrow pointing right followed by a vertical arrow pointing up, minus a horizontal arrow pointing left followed by a vertical arrow pointing down.